

Condor 4.0

Finding and requesting NSHD variables

A practical guide to searching, building baskets and saving them



What Condor does



Find variables

By name, keyword, category or library.

Collect them

Add one variable or many at a time. Linked variables come along too.

Check and save

Review your basket, then save it with a description.

Take it forward

Send your saved basket to LHA as part of a data request.

Condor gives you metadata: what each variable is, how it is coded and how it relates to others. The data itself is released later, through a data request to LHA.

Getting access

1 Register

Use Register in the menu and complete every field marked with an asterisk (*).

2 Email LHA

Send your username to MRCLHA.Swiftinfo@ucl.ac.uk so your account can be approved.

3 Wait for approval

LHA contacts you by email to confirm. Add their address to your safe senders list.

Confirm Password *

Fields marked * are mandatory.

Note: Please select a password that you can remember, with a maximum of 20 characters, using a combination of uppercase and lowercase letters and numbers.

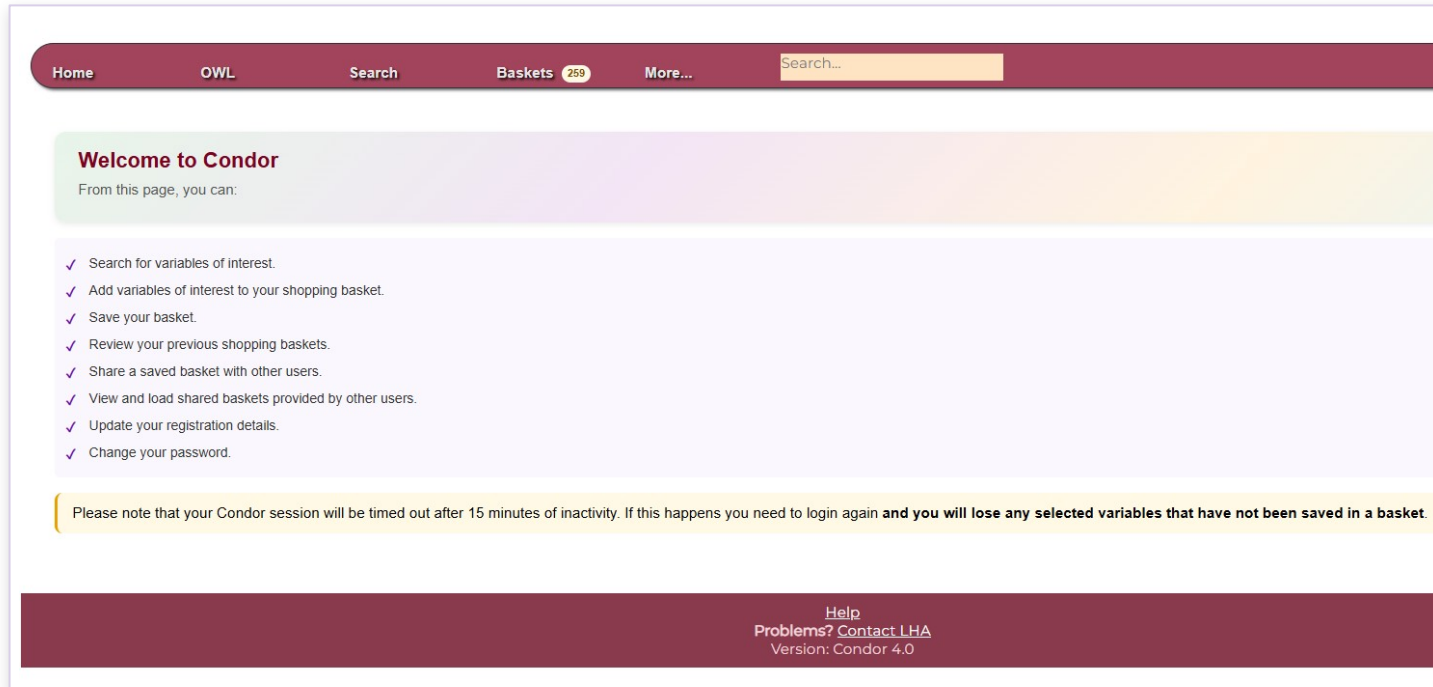
By submitting this form, you are agreeing to adhere to all MRC and LHA data security policies and procedures. In accordance with the Data Protection Act (1998) and General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR), we are collecting this information to provide you with access to the Condor service.

When you have completed this registration please send an email to MRCLHA.Swiftinfo@ucl.ac.uk so that we can process your registration.

We will contact you by email address to confirm your registration. Please make sure you provide a current email address and add MRCLHA.Swiftinfo@ucl.ac.uk to your safe senders list.

Register

Finding your way around



The menu bar

Home, OWL, Search, Baskets and More. Use Baskets to save, view, load or share.

The basket count

The badge beside Baskets shows how many variables you hold.

1-250

251-500

Over 500

Your session times out after 15 minutes of inactivity. Variables that have not been saved in a basket are lost, so save before you take a break.

Four ways to search

[Home](#) [OWL](#) [Search](#) [Baskets](#) 259 [More...](#)

Search help

Four ways to find data, depending on what you already know. Pick a section below to jump straight into that search.

BY CATEGORY

Browse the full category tree and expand or collapse branches to find the section you need. Parent categories may show zero items themselves — expand them to see the item totals for their subcategories. Currently selected categories are marked with a black bar to the left of the label. Numbers in square brackets are Showcase category labels.

[Search by category →](#)

BY VARIABLE NAME

Use this when you already know, or can guess, the exact or partial name of a variable. This searches variable names directly rather than their descriptions or categories. Add a trailing * for a wildcard match (e.g. gluc*), use +word to require a term or -word to exclude one, and wrap a phrase in "quotes" for an exact match. Searching just * on its own returns everything you have permission to see.

[Search by name →](#)

BY KEYWORD

Search by a word or phrase that might appear in a variable's label or description, rather than its formal name. Useful when you know roughly what you're looking for but not its exact variable name.

[Search by keyword →](#)

BY LIBRARY

Search within a specific data library or collection, if you already know which library the variable you need belongs to.

[Search by library →](#)

Name search tips: a trailing * is a wildcard (gluc*), +word requires a term, -word excludes one, "quotes" match an exact phrase, and * on its own returns everything you can see.

Browsing by category

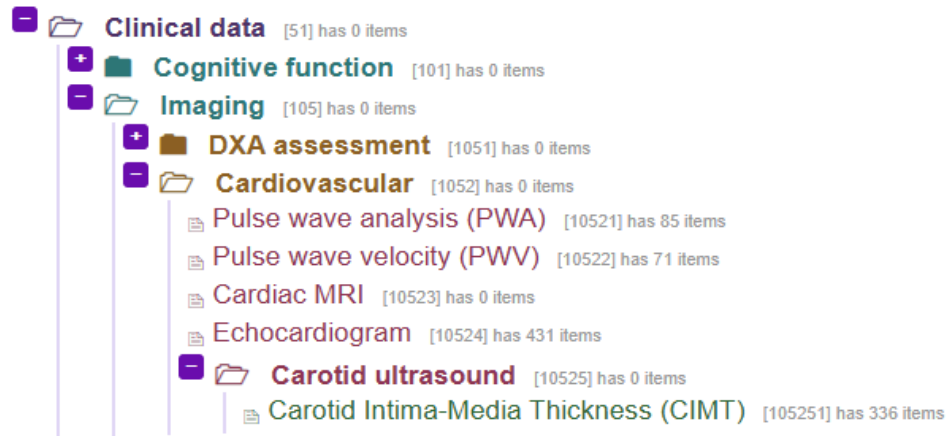
NSHD Search by Category

Browse the full category tree to find the section you need.

Search

Parent categories may show zero items. Expand these to see subcategory items.

Category Selected: Carotid ultrasound [10525] has 0 items



1 Expand or collapse

Click + or - beside a branch to open or close it.

2 Read the counts

Grey numbers show items per category. Parents may show 0: expand them to find the variables.

3 Select a category

Your choice appears in the Category Selected bar at the top.

4 Search

Click the Search button to list every variable in that category.

Reading your results

 = Available on OWL — click the icon to view this variable's metadata page on OWL.
 = Restricted — hover the icon for details.

Variable Name ▲▼	Description ▲▼
pret1_glob_myft  	Native T1 global mean - Myofit sub-study
pret1_glob_sd_myft  	Native T1 global sd - Myofit sub-study
pret1_sl1_myocardial_myft  	Native T1 slice 1 myocardial mean (basal LV) - Myofit sub-study
pret1_sl2_myocardial_myft  	Native T1 slice 2 myocardial mean (mid LV) - Myofit sub-study
pret1_sl3_myocardial_myft  	Native T1 slice 3 myocardial mean (apical LV) - Myofit sub-study
pret1_sl1_bld_myft  	Native T1 slice 1 blood mean (basal LV) - Myofit sub-study
pret1_sl2_bld_myft  	Native T1 slice 2 blood mean (mid LV) - Myofit sub-study



Owl icon

This variable is also on OWL. Click the icon to open its OWL page in a new tab.



Padlock icon

Access to this variable is restricted. Hover over the icon to see the reason.

Sort any table

Click a column header to sort, and click again to reverse.

The variable page

VARIABLE DETAILS

 = Available on OWL — click the icon to view this variable's metadata page on OWL.

Variable	ghi09 
Field ID	8639
Label	How is your health in general? - at age 60-64 years
Card Number	SF3609
Form	Postal questionnaire
Question	1
Year	2006-10
Derived Status	0
Later Version	NA
Units	Not applicable
Sensitive	0
Reason Public	NA
Reason Sensitive	NA
Notes	Self rated health and quality of life, SF36, Q59-Q67

[Variable details](#)[Linked and longitudinal](#)[Documents](#)[Categories](#)[Value labels](#)[Distribution](#)

Value labels list every code and what it means. The distribution shows how many participants gave each answer; missing values and very small groups are left out to protect privacy.

Longitudinal and linked variables

Truly longitudinal

Same Showcase Field ID: identical wording and coding, so results are directly comparable across sweeps.

Linked

Connected by a shared measure, but wording or coding may differ. Check before treating them as comparable.

LINKED AND LONGITUDINAL VARIABLES

 = Available on OWL — click the icon to view that variable's metadata page on OWL.

Variable ▲▼	Description ▲▼	Year ▲▼	Form ▲▼	Question ▲▼	Library File ▲▼
 ghi14x	How is your health in general? - at age 68 years	2014	Postal questionnaire	16	SelfRatedHealth14
 ghi22x	How is your health in general? - at age 76 years	2022	Postal questionnaire	20	Postal22
 ghi23x	How is your health in general? - at age 77 years.	2023	Home visit	10	medical_review23
 ghi25x	How is your health in general? - at age 79 years	2025	Postal questionnaire	7	Postal2025

Adding variables to your basket

Add one variable

Click the Σ in the Add to Basket column.

Add several

Tick the Multiple Add boxes, then click Multiple Add. Check ALL ticks every box on the page.

Check ALL

Multiple Add

 = Available on OWL — click the icon to view this variable's metadata page on OWL.

Variable Name ▲▼	Description ▲▼	Year ▼ ▲▼	Form ▼ ▲▼	Question ▲▼	Library File ▼ ▲▼	Add to Basket? ▲▼	Multiple Add? ▲▼
adv50	Mother's willingness to accept advice from Health Visitor 1950	1950	1950 AN2	26b	Y20	Σ	☒
arm 	Do you have difficulty because of long term health problems using either arm to reach up high above your head or to reach behind to tuck a shirt in or do up a zip? - at age 53 years	1999	A - Main CAPI questionnaire	78	capi99a	Σ	☒
arm89 	Due to long-term health problems or physical or mental disabilities do you have difficulty using arms to reach or stretch for things? - at age 43 years	1989	B - Self completion	Section D - 1(e)	de89d	Σ	☒
balinth15x 	Balance - health reason (string) - at age 69 years	2015	Home visit	2	PhysPerf15	Σ	☐
bath09 	Is it difficult because of long-term health problems, bathing and showering - at age 60-64 years	2006-10	Nurse schedule	54(b)	PhysCap09	Σ	☐

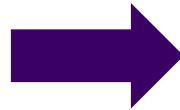
Adding a large selection shows a "please wait" screen. That is normal.

Linked variables come too

You add

htn23x

Standing height in cm, at age 77



Added automatically (13 in this example)

ht57u age 11

ht53u age 7

ht52u age 6

ht99u age 53

+ 9 more

The same measure at other ages.

Why?

They measure the same thing at other ages, so you don't have to find each one yourself.

Restricted variables

Never added, even as linked. They are listed with the reason instead.

Don't want them?

Use the Keep linked variables toggle on the next slides.

Uploading a data dictionary

[Home](#) [OWL](#) [Search](#) [Baskets](#) 641 [More...](#)

Upload Data Dictionary

Add every variable from a saved data dictionary spreadsheet to your Condor basket in one go.

Upload either a basket file you downloaded earlier from OWL, or the full Data Dictionary spreadsheet with variables marked **Y** in the *Request variable* column. Nothing is added to your basket until you review the list below and confirm.

↑ Upload saved data dictionary

After choosing a file

▶ 4 row(s) marked Y have no NSHD Variable Name (skipped): [\(click for details\)](#)

▶ 9 variable(s) have something other than Y in "Request variable" (skipped): [\(click for details\)](#)

531 variable(s) found in this file, ready to add.

Confirm & Add to Basket

Cancel

Two ways to build the list

Complete the Data Dictionary spreadsheet by hand, or download a basket you built on OWL.

Where to find it

Upload Data Dictionary, at the end of the OWL menu.

Checked before adding

Missing names, invalid values, and duplicates are all flagged first.

The Basket Management page

Basket Management

The result of your most recent add-to-basket action.

 = Available on OWL — click the icon to view that variable's metadata page on OWL.

☒ Keep linked variables

Turn off to remove the 13 variables added automatically alongside your search, keeping only the ones you added directly. You can turn this back on at any time to restore them, so an accidental toggle isn't permanent.

1 added (Successfully added to your basket.)

13 added as linked (Added automatically alongside a variable you searched for, because it belongs to the same longitudinal measure.)

0 restricted (Not added — access to this variable is restricted. See the message for details.)

Show: **All**

Variable Name ⬆	Label ⬆	Result ⬆	Category ⬆
htn23x 	Standing Height in cm - at age 77 years	This variable has been added, or was previously in your basket.	Added
ht57u 	Standing Height in cm - at age 11 years	This variable has also been added to your basket because it is a repeated measure or part of a scale	Linked
ht53u 	Standing Height in cm - at age 7 years	This variable has also been added to your basket because it is a repeated measure or part of a scale	Linked
ht52u 	Standing Height in cm - at age 6 years	This variable has also been added to your basket because it is a repeated measure or part of a scale	Linked
ht99u 	Standing Height in cm - at age 53 years	This variable has also been added to your basket because it is a repeated measure or part of a scale	Linked

Added

The variables you chose.

Added as linked

Came along automatically.

Restricted

Could not be added.

The Show dropdown filters the table to restricted, added or linked rows. Each row shows the variable name, its label, the result and its category.

Keep or remove linked variables

Switch off

Removes the linked variables and keeps the one you chose.

Switch back on

Restores exactly the same linked variables.

Your latest add only

Earlier variables in your basket are not touched.

Restricted variables

Never added, so the toggle does not affect them.

Toggle ON: 1 added + 13 linked

☒ **Keep linked variables**
Turn off to remove the 13 variables added automatically alongside your search, keeping only the ones you added directly. You can turn this back on at any time to restore them, so an accidental toggle isn't permanent.

1 added

(Successfully added to your basket.)

13 added as linked

(Added automatically alongside a variable you searched for, because it belongs to the same longitudinal measure.)

0 restricted

(Not added — access to this variable is restricted. See the message for details.)

Show: All

Toggle OFF: 1 added, 0 linked

☐ **Keep linked variables**
Turn off to remove the 13 variables added automatically alongside your search, keeping only the ones you added directly. You can turn this back on at any time to restore them, so an accidental toggle isn't permanent.

1 added

(Successfully added to your basket.)

0 added as linked

(Added automatically alongside a variable you searched for, because it belongs to the same longitudinal measure.)

0 restricted

(Not added — access to this variable is restricted. See the message for details.)

Show: All

Viewing your current basket

Basket Details

Everything currently in your working basket. Remove anything you don't need, or save it once you're ready.

You have 18 variables in your basket.

 = Available on OWL — click the icon to view this variable's metadata page on OWL.

SERNO and NTAG1 are automatically included in every basket and are not shown in the list below.

Remove? 	Variable 	Label 	Form 	Year 
	sex	Sex of the participant	Various	1946
	inf	Inflation factor to adjust for stratified sample	Various	1996
	htn23x 	Standing Height in cm - at age 77 years	Home visit	2023
	ht82u 	Standing Height in cm - at age 36 years	A - Main questionnaire	1982
	ht50u 	Standing Height in cm - at age 4 years	AN2 - Mother's interview by nurse	1950
	ht72u 	Standing Height in cm - at age 26 years	Section A - Main questionnaire	1972

Remove
Click the scissors, or use Remove All.

Protected
SEX and INF cannot be removed.

Hidden
SERNO and NTAG1 are always included.

The message above the table reflects the size of your basket:

Up to 250: a plain note

251 to 500: within the recommended range

Over 500: slower risk assessment

Saving a basket

The screenshot shows the 'Enter Basket Details' form for a basket named 'i.shahZZyxpofj'. The form has a header bar with 'Home', 'OWL', 'Search', 'Baskets 18', and 'More...'. Below the header, there's a section titled 'Enter Basket Details for i.shahZZyxpofj' with a subtitle 'Give your basket a description and save it, ready to finalise or come back to later.' A green box indicates 'You have 18 variables in this basket.' The main form area has a title 'Your new basket will be called i.shahZZyxpofj. You must enter a description for this basket:' followed by a text input field containing 'Heights|of participants'. Below the input field, it says 'Required, up to 100 characters. 77 characters remaining'. A purple 'Submit' button is at the bottom.

1

Open Save from the Baskets menu.

2

Type a clear description. The counter shows how many of the 100 characters are left.

3

Click Submit. A "please wait" screen shows while it saves.

4

A read-only confirmation lists what was saved.

Use specific descriptions. Saved baskets are listed by creation date, so a vague name is hard to find later.

Saving a large basket

Home
OWL
Search
Baskets 824
More...

Enter Basket Details for i.shahZZmvmlsb

Give your basket a description and save it, ready to finalise or come back to later.

You have 824 variables in your basket. This basket of variables will entail a more laborious, and therefore slower, process.

Because this exceeds the recommended limit of 500 variables per basket, it will be saved as **2 separate baskets**.

- i.shahZZmvmlsb_1
- i.shahZZmvmlsb_2

SERNO, SEX, INF and NTAG1 will be included in every one of these baskets automatically.

Your basket will be saved as the 2 baskets listed above. You must enter a description to use for all of them:

Required, up to 100 characters. 100 characters remaining

Submit

Over 500 variables

The basket is split automatically. SERNO, SEX, INF and NTAG1 are not counted.

Preview first

The form lists each new basket ID before you commit.

In every basket

SERNO, SEX, INF and NTAG1 are added to each split basket.

One description

It is reused, with (Basket 1 of 2) and so on added for you.

How large requests are reviewed

500

variables is the recommended maximum for one saved basket

Reviewed together

Split baskets are assessed as one overall request, not as separate submissions.

Larger takes longer

More variables need a more thorough risk assessment before data can be released.

You may be asked why

Over 500 variables in total? LHA may ask you to justify the request, even when it was split into several baskets.

Before saving: review your basket and remove anything you do not need, especially linked variables you did not ask for.

Requesting your Condor basket

Requesting your Condor basket

Condor builds the basket. Skylark is where you turn it into a request.

Condor gives you the metadata and the tools to build a basket — it doesn't hold the data itself, or submit a request on your behalf. Which form you need next depends on where your project is:

Haven't submitted a proposal yet?

If you're still exploring — checking what's available in Condor before committing to a project — this is the form that starts a new request.

[Data Access Request Form →](#)

Already have an approved project?

Use this to add the variables in your saved basket — or additional users — to a project that's already been approved.

[Additional Users / Data Request Form →](#)

New to this?

Still exploring? Use the Data Access Request Form to start a new proposal.

Already approved?

Use Additional Users / Data Request to add this basket to an existing project.

Found at the end of the OWL menu, and linked directly from the basket-saved confirmation page.

Loading, sharing and downloading

Load / Share My Basket

Your saved baskets, newest first. Select one to load it into your working basket, or share it with other users.

Load Shared Basket

Baskets other users have shared. Load one the same way.

Download Basket

Export a saved basket for use outside Condor.

Load / Share My Basket

List of Saved Baskets

Every basket you've saved previously, ordered by when it was created. Select one to load it back into your working basket.

Basket ID	Description	Share?	Load?
Bshlcslyl8ms	cancer	+	+
Begzrs49eqm5	test	+	+
B179e0o05j11oa	steph test	+	+
Bgahzw8s59er1	ECG09	+	+
B13gq5k1q0xj4i	HRV09	+	+
BtrxBujot5lyg	PWA PWV 2009 cleaned	+	+
B1bx63m6dxh4ds	mbwfu	+	+
B691j9et0azst	PWA09	+	+

After loading a basket

Basket Management

The result of loading this basket.

Available on OWL — click the icon to view that variable's metadata page on OWL.

84 added (in this basket)
0 restricted (Not added — access to this variable is restricted. See the message for details.)

Show: All

Variable Name	Label	Result	Category
ecgse2n709	SERIAL TYPE2_7 Minnesota code changes for Q-QS Patterns and T-waves - Posterior (only applicable if two or more ECG records per patient) at 60-64 years	This variable has been added, or was previously in your basket.	Added
ecgs2n1609	SERIAL TYPE2_16 Minnesota code changes for LBBB (only applicable if two or more ECG records per patient) at 60-64 years	This variable has been added, or was previously in your basket.	Added
ecgye09	ECG visit day - Year - at age 60-64 years	This variable has been added, or was previously in your basket.	Added
ecgqraxs09	QRS axis - Degree (ECG) at 60-64 years	This variable has been added, or was previously in your basket.	Added
ecgmst409	MINNESOTA group 4 - Anterolateral (ECG) at 60-64 years	This variable has been added, or was previously in your basket.	Added
ecgsmon09	ECG system date - Month - at age 60-64 years	This variable has been added, or was previously in your basket.	Added

Restricted variables

Variable Name ▲▼	Description ▲▼	Year ▲▼
aha_apicalseg_v ol_myft  	AHA apical segments volume - Myofit sub-study	2020-2024
aha_basalseg ol_myft  	Only available via special request. Contact  for access to these data. AHA basal segments volume - Myofit sub-study	2020-2024
aha_midseg_vol _myft  	AHA mid segments volume - Myofit sub-study	2020-2024



Never added, even as linked

Restricted variables still appear on Basket Management with the reason, so you can see what was left out.

What it means

You cannot add this variable to a basket.

Why?

Hover over the padlock to see the reason and who to ask.

Need access?

Contact LHA using the link in the site footer.

Condor and OWL

Condor

- ✓ Search by name, keyword, category or library
- ✓ Build, save, load and share baskets
- ✓ Prepare a data request for LHA
- ✓ Needs an approved Condor account

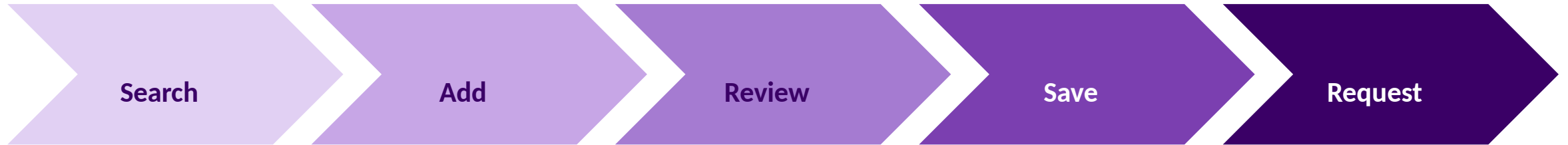
OWL



- ✓ Public metadata platform
- ✓ No Condor account needed
- ✓ Guided walkthrough for first-time users
- ✓ The owl icon in Condor links straight to a variable's OWL page

Find the guided walkthrough under the OWL menu in Condor.

Recap and where to get help



Get Started pages

In-app help from the menu, covering the same ground as this session.

OWL walkthrough

A short, hands-on introduction, from the OWL menu.

Contact LHA

For data access, restricted variables or sharing a basket, use the link in the site footer.

Remember: save before your session times out after 15 minutes of inactivity.